Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 467

RESOLUTION EXTENDING PROFOUND GRATITUDE AND APPRECIATION TO THE SUPPORT TO BANGSAMORO TRANSITION PROGRAM FOR ITS INVALUABLE CONTRIBUTION TO THE SUCCESS OF THE BENCHMARKING ACTIVITY OF THE BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY COMMITTEE ON WOMEN, YOUTH, CHILDREN, AND PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES AT THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES AND THE SENATE OF THE PHILIPPINES

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) established the Committee on Women, Youth, Children, and Persons with Disabilities (CWYCP) on November 22, 2022, through the adoption of Resolution No. 268, which provides for the rules, procedures, and practices of the BTA Parliament;

WHEREAS, Paragraph 17, Section 3, Rule XII of Adopted Resolution No. 268 provides that the CWYCP consists of twenty-five (25) Members and exercises jurisdiction over all matters concerning the representation, participation, welfare, and development of women, youth, children, and persons with disabilities within the Bangsamoro Region;

WHEREAS, Support to Bangsamoro Transition (SUBATRA) is a 5-year program funded by the European Union, and co-financed by the Spanish Agency for International Development Cooperation (AECID), through an agreement with the Government of the Philippines;

WHEREAS, the overarching objective of SUBATRA is to assist the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) in laying the groundwork for sustainable peace and development by strengthening the capacities of the region's institutions during the transition period;

WHEREAS, SUBATRA has extended support to the capacity building and other initiatives of CWCYP such as staff training on bill drafting, gender equity and social inclusion mainstreaming, gender-sensitive legislation, completed staff work, and strategic planning;

WHEREAS, SUBATRA also facilitated the first Benchmarking Activity for CWYCP over a three-day period from May 7 to 9, 2024. This enabled the scoping and immersion of women members of CWYCP with their national counterparts in the Philippine Congress, such as the House Committee on Women and Gender Equality, and the Senate Committee on Women, Children, Family Relations, and Gender Equality, thereby fostering a meaningful exchange of insights, legislative priorities, and best practices;

WHEREAS, Section 28 (jjj), Rule IX of Rules of the House of Representatives states that the House Committee on Women and Gender Equality (CWGE) is composed of fifty-five (55) Members and has jurisdiction over all matters directly and principally relating to the rights and welfare of women, including girl-children, inclusive of their education, employment, working conditions, their role in nation-building, and all concerns relating to gender equality;

WHEREAS, during the Benchmarking Activity at the House of Representatives, in attendance were CWYCP Chairperson Member of Parliament (MP) Diamila Disimban-Ramos, Subcommittee on Children Chairperson MP Sittie Fahanie Sindatok Uy-Oyod and Subcommittee on Person with Disabilities (PWD) Chairperson MP Tarhata Matalam Maglangit, as well as committee members MP Baintan Adil Ampatuan, MP Susana Salvador Anayatin, and MP NurRedha Ibrahim Misuari. Meanwhile, the CWGE members in attendance were Chairperson Hon. Geraldine B. Roman, Vice Chairpersons Hon. Ma. Rene Ann Lourdes G. Matibag and Hon. Ma. Cynthia K. Chan, as well as Members Hon. Jocelyn Sy Limkaichong, Hon. Raoul Daniel Manuel, Hon. Arlene Brosas, Hon. Milagros Aquino-Magsaysay, Hon. Amparo Maria J. Zamora, and Hon. France L. Castro;

WHEREAS, key takeaways from the activity include the following:

(a) The importance of inclusive and participatory legislative processes to ensure that the diverse needs and concerns of women from different regions and sectors are adequately represented;

(b) Effective oversight mechanisms to monitor the implementation and enforcement of laws related to women's rights and gender and development;

(c) Successful initiatives and best practices in promoting women's rights and empowerment, including the expanded Anti-Violence Against Women and Children Act, the Anti-Discrimination Bill, and the establishment of crisis assistance centers for women and children victims;

(d) Strategies for engaging civil society and the public in the legislative process to enhance transparency, accountability, and inclusivity;

(e) Continuous sharing of information and expertise between the committees;

(f) Entering into a *"sisterhood agreement"* between the committees; and

(g) And the visitation in BARMM of CWGE, headed by its Chairperson Hon. Roman, to reciprocate the efforts of CWYCP;

WHEREAS, Paragraph 40, Section 13, Rule X of Rules of The Senate provides that the Senate Committee on Women, Children, Family Relations and Gender Equality, composed of eleven (11) Members, is the national counterpart of CWYCP at the Senate of the Philippines. Said Senate Committee has jurisdiction over all matters relating to women, the welfare and protection of children, family relations, and equality before the law of women and men;

WHEREAS, the CWYCP delegation, led by Chairperson MP Diamila Disimban-Ramos, included Deputy Floor Leader MP Atty. Mary Ann Madroño Arnado, Subcommittee on Children Chairperson MP Sittie Fahanie Sindatok Uy-Oyod, Subcommittee on PWDs Chairperson MP Tarhata Matalam Maglangit, and committee members MP Baintan Adil Ampatuan, MP Susana Salvador Anayatin, and MP NurRedha Ibrahim Misuari. Meanwhile, the Senate Committee on Women, Children, Family Relations, and Gender Equality was represented by Chairperson Senator Risa Hontiveros, along with her key staff members;

WHEREAS, during the activity with the Senate Committee, key takeaways were identified, including the following:

(a) The importance of mutual learning and collaboration between the counterpart committees of the Senate and the BTA;

(b) The necessity of public consultations to ensure that legislation addresses the real needs and concerns of the communities;

(c) The critical role of legislative oversight to ensure the effectiveness of laws protecting women and children;

(d) The advocacy for an intersectional approach to legislative work, recognizing the complex interplay of gender with other social factors and lenses;

(e) The persistent challenges of sexism and misogyny within institutions and the need to confront these biases;

(f) The significant role of the women's movement in advocating for gender equality and supporting legislative efforts;

(g) The focus on key legislative areas to protect women and girls and ensure gender-responsive emergency management;

(h) The effective utilization of the Gender and Development budget to fund complementary programs and initiatives; and

(i) The encouragement for young women and men to embrace their roles as agents of positive change and to support gender and development initiatives;

WHEREAS, SUBATRA generously covered the majority of expenses associated with the Benchmarking Activity, including transportation services, hotel accommodations, meals, and active involvement throughout the actual conduct of the activity;

WHEREAS, the unwavering support and collaboration provided by SUBATRA, led by its National Key Expert Atty. Reginald Pastrana and his team, played a pivotal role in ensuring the seamless and successful implementation of the Benchmarking Activity. This support provided an invaluable platform for knowledge exchange and collaboration among participants and underscored SUBATRA's commitment to advancing women empowerment in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region;

WHEREAS, the resounding success achieved during the Benchmarking Activity stands as a testament to the collective efforts and collaborative spirit exemplified by SUBATRA and CWYCP, further reinforcing their partnership and cooperation;

WHEREAS, the BTA is deeply grateful to SUBATRA for its unwavering support and assistance, not only in organizing and executing the Benchmarking Activity of CWYCP at the House of Representatives and the Senate of the Philippines, but also in all its initiatives and contributions to the BARMM:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To extend profound gratitude and appreciation to the Support to Bangsamoro Transition Program for its invaluable contribution to the success of the Benchmarking Activity of the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Committee on Women, Youth, Children, and Persons with Disabilities at the House of Representatives and the Senate of the Philippines.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To furnish a copy of this Resolution to the Office of SUBATRA Program, the House Speaker and the House of Representatives' Committee on Women and Gender Equality, and the Senate Committee on Women, Children, Family Relations and Gender Equality to the Senate President as a token of our gratitude and appreciation as well as for this resolution's necessary effects.

ADOPTED, *Dhu Al-Hijjah* 18, 1445/June 24, 2024.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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